NCCP 00689 · VERSION 4

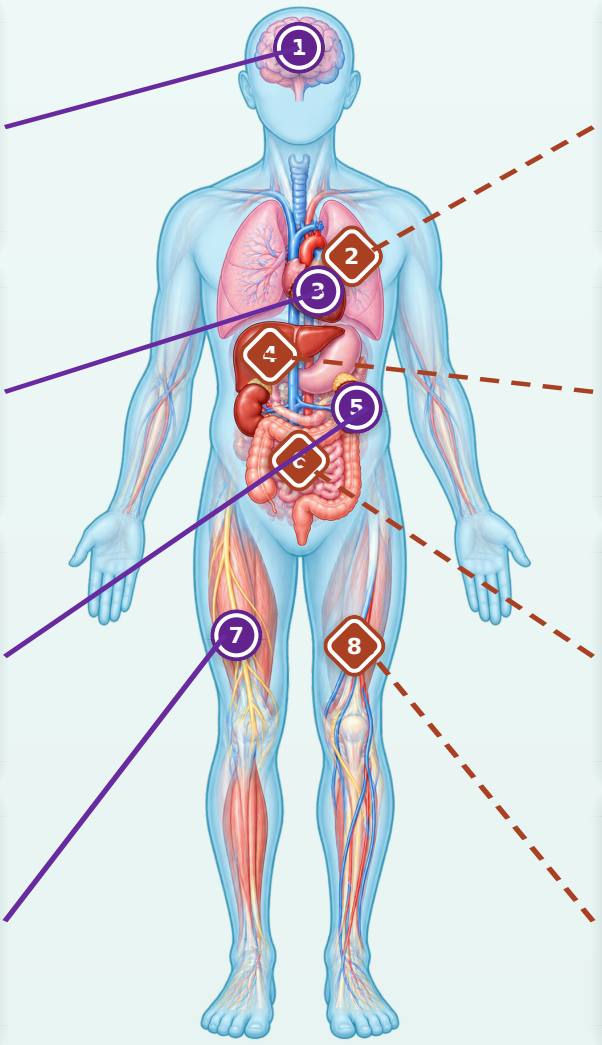
Atezolizumab + carboplatin + etoposide

Induction: atezolizumab and carboplatin on Day 1, with etoposide on Days 1–3, repeated every 21 days for up to four cycles. Maintenance: carboplatin and etoposide stop; atezolizumab alone continues every 21 days while appropriate. The fourth cycle ends about 12 weeks after starting if there are no delays; maintenance has no fixed total duration in this regimen.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.



1 Hormones / brain

Atezolizumab

Unusual weakness, dizziness, headache, thirst or frequent urination: report promptly.

2 Lungs

Atezolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment; infection, cancer or clot can look similar.

3 Heart

Atezolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Atezolizumab / etoposide

Report yellow skin/eyes or dark urine; tests may detect changes before symptoms.

5 Kidneys

Atezolizumab / carboplatin dosing

Report much less urine, swelling or persistent vomiting; kidney results affect the plan.

6 Bowel / mouth

Atezolizumab / etoposide

New diarrhoea, severe pain, mouth ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

7 Skin / muscles / nerves

Atezolizumab / chemotherapy

Report spreading rash, blisters, weakness, tingling or difficulty with daily tasks.

8 Blood / infection

Carboplatin / etoposide

Fever, shivers, bleeding or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact your oncology team immediately for fever or shivering, sudden illness even without a fever, new or worse breathlessness, diarrhoea, severe rash or unusual weakness. Severe chest pain, collapse, confusion or major breathing difficulty need emergency help. Show your immunotherapy alert card; immune effects can begin after treatment ends. Report new muscle weakness, drooping eyelids or difficulty swallowing immediately, especially with chest symptoms or breathlessness; immune effects on muscles, nerves and the heart can occur together.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Atezolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, hormone glands, skin, heart, muscles or nerves
- Serious infusion or SC-related reactions
- Some effects require prolonged treatment or lasting hormone replacement

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection, anaemia and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Allergic reactions; renal function affects dosing

Etoposide

- Low blood counts and infection
- Hair loss, mouth soreness, nausea and bowel changes
- Infusion reactions or low blood pressure during administration
- Possible later treatment-related leukaemia; discuss longer-term risks

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Day 1 carboplatin anti-sickness plan

Carboplatin has a high sickness risk. Your prescription usually includes several anti-sickness medicines with some doses on later days. Follow the written plan even if you initially feel well; contact the team if it is not effective.

Days 2–3 etoposide and the days afterwards

The team should account for each chemotherapy day and for two days after the last dose. The later-day plan may overlap the medicines already started on Day 1, so obtain one clear schedule and do not add duplicate doses. Confirm the plan for oral etoposide separately.

Maintenance support changes

When only atezolizumab remains, routine chemotherapy anti-sickness steroids and other prophylaxis are not automatically continued. Keep any individual rescue or hormone-replacement plan and the immunotherapy alert card. Do not stop prescribed long-term steroids yourself.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00689/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.